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General Comment

Artificial intelligence requires regulation. It's simply a truth, as most human commodities and products also require regulation, but it rings especially true for artificial intelligence, as very few other human creations have the same amount of powers, risks, and implications.

To preface, artificial intelligence (henceforth abbreviated to "AI"), particularly "generative" AI capable of producing text, image, and sound data based on prompts, requires training on similar data first. The exact source of training data tends to vary depending on the exact purpose of a particular AI, but the sets of training data used will often be comprised of anywhere from thousands to millions of entries.

The methods and contexts of collecting training data is a serious issue, and must be taken seriously. It is common for generative AI to be trained on information collected from millions of people as scraped on the internet. While there is a whole rights issue that is worth discussion about the use of the work of small-time creators, I would like to highlight something else with this comment:

The scraping of the internet for training information will almost inevitably capture the copyrighted works of large companies such as Disney, Comcast, Warner Brothers, and others.

By nature of the internet, copyrighted material will appear on it, whether officially (as posted by the companies themselves), or unofficially (as posted by individuals). An AI scraping the internet for training data is, given enough time, certain to inadvertently collect the copyrighted works of large companies that would likely prefer to retain control over their properties.

Allowing AI unrestricted access to copyrighted materials would be liable to damage the business of these major media companies, which are important for the American economy as major cultural touchstones, particularly as allowing AI access to copyrighted material for some companies sets a precedent for others to claim fair use of copyrighted material under the notion of AI use.

I believe that AI should NOT be allowed unrestricted access to copyrighted material, as this may lead to the deconstruction of the concept of copyright as a whole. Rather, I believe that all AI should be subject to regulation that requires them to source their training data with express legal permission from the copyright holder. Regulation of AI in this way gives America the precedent to retain control of its assets, helping to restrict the influence of malicious actors that don't align with American interests